

The ultimate danger of the disease model: the total removal of personal accountability.

From the Documentary "Pleasure Unwoven "

A Theological and Logical Framework on Substance Use: Choice vs. Disease

I. The Origin of Addiction: The Root and the Fruit

* **The Theological Framework:** Addiction is defined by cause and effect. The *choice* to use the substance is the root, and the brain rewiring is the fruit. Without the initial behavioral choice, the physical condition cannot exist. There is no documented case in human history of an individual developing the specific brain rewiring of substance use disorder without first making the behavioral choice to use drugs or alcohol. Therefore, the "disease" cannot exist without the choice.

* **The Video Outline:** The video flips this hierarchy. While it acknowledges that drug-taking begins as a behavior, it argues that the substance chemically hijacks the unconscious survival center (the midbrain). It categorizes addiction primarily as a biological "defect" in the brain's processing pipeline, attempting to minimize the role of the initial choice once the brain is exposed to the chemical.

II. The Reality of Genetic "Predisposition"*

* **The Theological Framework:** Genetics (the 40% to 60% factor) represent nothing more than a dormant vulnerability. If a person is never exposed to the substance through behavioral choice, that genetic risk drops entirely to zero. You are not predetermined to be a drug addict. Genetics are powerless without the catalyst of human behavior and choice.

* **The Video Outline:** The video categorizes genetics as the literal "first level" of the disease process. It frames this biological vulnerability not as a dormant trait waiting on a choice, but as the foundational defect in a physiological illness.

III. The Role of Environment vs. Personal Agency

* **The Theological Framework:** While environmental factors (upbringing, surroundings, trauma) heavily influence a person's vulnerability, they do not bypass free will. If an environment of substance exposure is removed, the manifestation of addiction disappears. This proves that the condition relies entirely on access and action, rather than an inescapable biological pathology.

* **The Video Outline:** The video relies on neurochemicals like Dopamine and Glutamate to argue that the brain undergoes permanent "hyper-memory" learning. It claims this chemical determinism causes relapses long after the environment changes, framing the brain as permanently broken rather than simply responding to a chosen behavior.

****IV. The Concept of Pleasure: The Consequence of Choice vs. Artificial Hijacking****

* ****The Theological Framework:**** Pursuing artificial, intoxicating pleasure through substances is a willful behavioral choice—an "act of the flesh" driven by human desires rather than the fruit of the Spirit. If a person's brain becomes numb to normal, everyday joys, it is the direct physical **consequence** (the fruit) of repeatedly choosing an extreme, artificial high (the root). The comparison the video makes between addiction and being blind or deaf is a ridiculous false equivalence because it completely ignores **causation**. Blindness and deafness are almost entirely involuntary physical realities. The "broken pleasure sense" of addiction is willfully self-inflicted. Furthermore, society does not incarcerate addicts for experiencing a lack of pleasure; individuals are incarcerated for the illegal actions, property crimes, and dangerous behaviors (like DUI) resulting from their chosen substance use.

* ****The Video Outline:**** The video defines addiction fundamentally as a disease of the brain's "hedonic system" (its pleasure sense). It argues that drugs cause massive dopamine surges that trick the midbrain into equating the substance with survival, eventually making the person "pleasure deaf" to normal life. The video explicitly compares this state to being blind or deaf. It argues that just as society does not jail a blind person for failing to perceive light, it is unjust to jail an addict for a broken pleasure sense, claiming that addicts are only incarcerated because the concept of pleasure carries societal moral baggage.

****V. Free Will and Craving: Capturing Thoughts vs. Hypofrontality****

* ****The Theological Framework:**** Free will remains the ultimate gatekeeper. The "gun to the head" choice argument perfectly illustrates that individuals maintain personal agency and can alter their behavior when faced with severe enough consequences. Regarding cravings, a biblical worldview recognizes them not as an incurable disease, but as intense temptations of the flesh. Scripture commands believers to "take captive every thought" (2 Corinthians 10:5) and to be transformed by the renewing of the mind (Romans 12:2). Furthermore, Scripture states that it is only when desire has conceived that it gives birth to sin (James 1:15). The initial thought or craving is not a sin or the behavior itself; it is simply the temptation. To use a classic analogy: **You cannot stop a bird from flying over your head, but you can stop it from building a nest in your hair.** Just thinking about the substance briefly is the bird flying over your head. It is only the action taken—the behavioral choice to entertain the thought and act upon it (letting it build a nest)—that becomes the sinful behavior. Cravings can be managed, disciplined, and transformed through mental and spiritual fortitude.

* ****The Video Outline:**** The video introduces "hypofrontality," claiming the rational, decision-making center of the brain becomes severely impaired. It argues that the "Choice Argument" fails because, even if a person can momentarily stop their behavior with a gun to their head, they cannot consciously choose to stop the **craving**. The video states that craving is an intense, emotional, obsessional experience, and it explicitly separates the physical craving

from the behavioral choice, arguing that because the addict cannot control the involuntary craving, the craving itself is the disease.

****VI. The Core Worldview: Moral Accountability vs. Medical Pathology****

* **The Theological Framework:** Aligned with Galatians 5:21-23, behaviors such as drunkenness and *pharmakeia* (witchcraft/drug use) are "acts of the flesh." They are behavioral choices that carry moral and spiritual accountability, requiring behavioral transformation, repentance, and the application of the fruit of the Spirit to overcome.

* **The Video Outline:** The video's primary goal is to actively remove the concept of morality or "badness" from the equation. By explicitly classifying addiction alongside a chronic condition like diabetes or a broken leg, it seeks to shift the narrative entirely away from behavioral accountability and spiritual transformation, replacing it with medical pathology and symptom management.

****VII. Conclusion: The Removal of Personal Responsibility****

Ultimately, the "disease of addiction" theory systematically strips all personal responsibility away from the individual. By labeling substance use an involuntary medical condition, it inherently legitimizes destructive behavior and provides a built-in excuse to continue using. If an individual truly "cannot help themselves" due to a diseased brain, the secular logic naturally concludes that there should be no punitive consequences or moral judgments for their actions. This worldview stands in direct and complete opposition to biblical teaching. Scripture places immense weight on personal accountability; individuals are responsible for their choices, their behaviors, and the consequences those choices yield. True transformation cannot occur when behavior is excused as an incurable disease; it only happens when a person takes full ownership of their actions, accepts accountability, and actively chooses to walk a different path.

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